

AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. — Comprehensive Attendance & Work Hours Policy

Section 1: Purpose / Definition

AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. (hereinafter referred to as "AstraNova" or "the Company") values flexibility, operational efficiency, and cross-functional synergy. As an AI-First Organization, we balance a highly collaborative work culture with robust delivery metrics. The purpose of the Attendance & Work Hours Policy is to establish clear operational guidelines regarding business hours, core collaboration windows, time-tracking procedures, and punctuality expectations. This framework ensures our product engineering, data analytics, and cloud infrastructure teams remain seamlessly synchronized to meet customer-centric commitments while respecting individual work-life integration.

Section 2: Scope

This policy applies to all permanent full-time employees, part-time employees, and interns operating out of the AstraNova physical headquarters in Pune, Maharashtra, as well as those functioning under authorized hybrid or fully remote work arrangements within India. Third-party contractors and external consultants are expected to fulfill the specific service hours stipulated within their respective master vendor agreements, using the standard tracking frameworks outlined below unless otherwise specified.

Section 3: Eligibility

All covered individuals must adhere to the scheduling, time-logging, and accessibility frameworks detailed in this document starting from their official date of appointment or onboarding. There is no minimum tenure requirement; compliance is mandatory across all functional departments, seniority levels, and operational roles.

Section 4: Rules & Guidelines

4.1 Standard Work Week and Core Collaboration Hours

AstraNova operates on a standard 40-hour work week, distributed across 5 working days from Monday through Friday. To foster collaborative software development, machine learning sprints, and organizational alignment, the Company designates mandatory daily **Core Collaboration Hours**:

- **Standard Business Windows:** Teams generally distribute their daily 8-hour shift between 9:00 AM IST and 7:00 PM IST.
- **Mandatory Core Hours:** All employees—regardless of their physical location or hybrid status—must be online, accessible, and actively engaged on corporate channels between **11:00 AM IST and 4:00 PM IST**.
- **Weekend Operations:** Saturday and Sunday are designated weekly off-days, except for specialized 24/7 technical operations teams operating on rolling shift patterns.

4.2 Time Tracking and Attendance Recording

Accurate attendance tracking is essential for operational transparency and automated payroll integration. Employees must log their time daily using the following institutional channels:

- **On-Site Tracking:** When working physically at the Pune office, employees must record their entry and exit points using the biometric access control systems installed at all primary office bays.
- **Remote/Hybrid Tracking:** When working from an authorized remote location, employees must utilize the web check-in and check-out functionalities within the centralized Human Resources Information System (HRIS) portal.
- **Single-Log Rule:** Splitting logs between biometric systems and web portals within a single calendar day is prohibited unless a mid-day location change is explicitly pre-approved by the manager.

4.3 Punctuality and Unexcused Absences

- **Late Arrival Threshold:** Any initial daily log-in or biometric punch occurring after 11:00 AM IST without a prior manager-approved flexible arrangement is automatically flagged by the system as a late arrival.
- **Escalation Trigger:** An accumulation of more than three unexcused late arrivals within a single calendar month will automatically trigger a system alert to the reporting manager and initiate a formal operational review.
- **Unplanned Absence Notification:** If an unexpected personal emergency or sudden medical incident prevents an employee from logging in, they must send an email or Slack notification to their direct manager by **10:00 AM IST** on the day of the absence.

- **Absence Regularization:** Any missed time log or unexpected absence must be regularized through a formal request within the HRIS portal within 3 working days of the occurrence. Unregularized logs at the end of the monthly payroll cycle will be treated as an unauthorized Loss of Pay (LOP) absence.

Section 5: Process / Workflow

The tracking, review, and management of corporate attendance metrics follow a continuous, automated weekly loop inside the AstraNova HR infrastructure:

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Employee logs daily check-in/out via Biometrics or Web HRIS
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HRIS automatically aggregates logs into weekly team attendance
reports
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Manager conducts weekly review of anomalies (e.g., missed punches,
late arrivals)
↓
Employee submits Regularization Request via HRIS for any flagged gaps
↓
Manager issues systemic Approval or Rejection based on justification
↓
Validated attendance data securely pushes to Payroll Processing on
the 25th
```

Section 6: Roles & Responsibilities

6.1 Employee

- **Systemic Compliance:** Consistently record accurate log-in and log-out data using the assigned biometric systems or HRIS interfaces.
- **Availability Guarantee:** Maintain full availability on enterprise communication platforms (Slack, Microsoft Teams) during the 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST core window.
- **Proactive Regularization:** Actively monitor personal attendance logs and clear any automated system discrepancies within the mandated 3-day window.

6.2 Reporting Manager

- **Schedule Oversight:** Review and validate team attendance logs, shift rotations, and regularization requests on a weekly basis.

- **Bias-Free Management:** Evaluate late-arrival justifications consistently, maintaining transparency and equity across the team.
- **Performance Tracking:** Address chronic absenteeism or punctuality lapses early through dedicated 1-on-1 coaching conversations before formal HR intervention becomes necessary.

6.3 HR Department

- **System Maintenance:** Maintain the technical integrity of the biometric infrastructure and HRIS attendance modules.
- **Operational Audits:** Perform monthly structural audits on organizational attendance trends, providing reports to leadership regarding compliance gaps.
- **Disciplinary Execution:** Administer formal warning frameworks and corrective action plans for unresolved attendance policy violations.

Section 7: Exceptions

7.1 Shift Rotations and 24/7 Technical Operations

Employees assigned to Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), Cloud Infrastructure Security, or 24/7 Technical Support desks operate on rotating 8-hour shift rosters. These teams are exempt from the standard 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST core collaboration hour window. Their specific working hours, break periods, and handover protocols are governed by a roster published by the Operations Head on the 20th of every preceding month.

7.2 Extraordinary Technical and Incapacitating Incidents

- **Extended Power/Internet Outages:** If a remote worker experiences an extended local infrastructure failure lasting greater than 3 hours during core hours, they must alert their manager via telephone. The manager can authorize a temporary pivot to a local co-working space or waive the core hour requirement for that day.
- **Severe Medical Incapacitation:** The standard 10:00 AM IST morning notification threshold is waived if an employee is hospitalized or incapacitated due to an acute medical emergency, provided a family member alerts the HR department within 24 hours of the incident.

Section 8: Examples

- **Scenario A (Attendance Regularization for a Forgotten Punch):** A software developer working at the Pune headquarters swipes their biometric

card upon arrival at 9:30 AM IST. In the evening, they leave the office in a hurry to catch a corporate shuttle and forget to swipe out. The next day, the HRIS displays an "Incomplete Log" error. The developer opens the HRIS portal, submits an Attendance Regularization Request detailing their actual exit time, and the manager approves it based on verification of active Slack logs during those hours.

- **Scenario B (Managing Infrastructure Failures During Core Hours):** A machine learning engineer working remotely experiences a sudden city-wide power failure that knocks out their high-speed fiber broadband at 1:00 PM IST. The engineer immediately calls their direct manager using a mobile network to report the incident. Since the outage is estimated to last 4 hours, the manager instructs the engineer to log out for the day and utilize a pro-rated arrangement, ensuring critical code updates are handed over to a peer via telephone.
- **Scenario C (Chronic Late Arrival Escalation):** An operations analyst repeatedly logs into the HRIS portal between 11:30 AM and 12:00 PM IST without prior manager authorization. By the end of the month, the HRIS flags 5 instances of late arrival. The system automatically triggers an alert, prompting the reporting manager to conduct a formal 1-on-1 alignment meeting to evaluate the root cause and set clear expectations for punctuality.

Section 9: Important Notes

- **Avoid:** Do not engage in "proxy swiping"—asking a colleague to swipe your biometric card or log into your HRIS account to alter attendance records is considered fraudulent behavior. This constitutes a severe violation of the Code of Conduct and results in immediate disciplinary action up to termination.
- **Best Practice:** If you anticipate an unavoidable personal commitment (such as a medical check-up or government appointment) that will cause you to drop offline during the 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST core window, log it on your team's shared calendar at least 48 hours in advance and secure written manager validation.

Section 10: Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q1: What are the mandatory core collaboration hours at AstraNova?

A1: The mandatory core collaboration hours are from 11:00 AM IST to 4:00 PM IST, Monday through Friday. All standard employees must be online and available during this timeframe.

Q2: What should I do if I forget to check out on the HRIS portal while working remotely?

A2: You should log into the HRIS portal the next morning and submit an Attendance Regularization Request for the missing punch out, providing your actual end-of-day working time for manager approval.

Q3: How many unexcused late arrivals are permitted before the system triggers an escalation?

A3: The system permits up to three unexcused late arrivals (logging in after 11:00 AM IST without prior approval) per calendar month. A fourth instance automatically triggers a formal review flag.

Q4: Can I complete my 40-hour weekly requirement by working on Saturdays and Sundays?

A4: No. The standard work week runs from Monday through Friday. Weekend work cannot be used to compensate for missed core collaboration hours during the regular work week unless explicitly authorized by your Department Head.

Q5: What is the absolute deadline for regularizing a missed attendance log?

A5: All attendance anomalies, missing punches, or regularizations must be submitted via the HRIS portal within 3 working days of the occurrence to ensure accurate monthly payroll processing.

Q6: Are the core collaboration hours identical for the 24/7 technical support teams?

A6: No. SRE, infrastructure, and 24/7 support teams are exempt from the standard core hours. They follow dedicated 8-hour shift schedules published monthly by their respective Operations Heads.

Q7: By what time must I report an unplanned emergency absence to my manager?

A7: You must notify your reporting manager via email or Slack by 10:00 AM IST on the morning of your unplanned absence to ensure the team can adjust daily stand-up

tasks.

Q8: Can I alternate between web check-in and office biometrics on the same working day?

A8: No. You must use a consistent logging mechanism within a single day. Splitting logs between the portal and biometrics causes system errors, unless you have explicit manager approval for a mid-day change in work location.

Q9: What happens if I fail to clear or regularize a flagged attendance gap before the payroll cutoff?

A9: Any unregularized absence or incomplete time log remaining in the system during the payroll cutoff on the 25th of the month will be classified as an unauthorized Loss of Pay (LOP) day.

Q10: Can my manager customize my team's specific daily core working hours?

A10: Managers can specify exact team sync times around the corporate framework, but they cannot alter or waive the mandatory company-wide 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST core accessibility window without written authorization from the HR Director.